AI ON THE RISE · ZOMBIE STATS

AI quotes your market's numbers. Who checks the source?

Fewer than half of the stats AI cited led to a study that says the same.

Victor Slompo · vssolutions.io

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WHAT HAPPENED

Trakkr traced 1,285 stats from five AI assistants

Trakkr asked ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, Claude and Google AI Overviews for numbers, then followed each citation back, up to five pages deep. One stat, 44% of salespeople give up after one follow-up, had no study behind it. All five assistants said it.

THE NUMBER

40%

of traced stats reached a study that says the same thing

Another 8% reached the study, but the number or context had changed.

THE REAL PROBLEM IN COMPANIES

What I see in companies: nobody owns the number AI quotes

01 Old figures about your market sit on blogs and roundups, and AI repeats them.

02 The real data is buried in a PDF or behind a form that crawlers can't read.

03 Nobody checks what AI says about the company, so wrong numbers go unseen.

I'VE ALREADY SOLVED THIS

One of Brazil's largest cosmetics companies: a report AI can cite

01 Annual report rebuilt: server-rendered HTML in 3 languages, Schema.org/JSON-LD, llms.txt

02 17 AI crawlers allowed by name, with an in-house log collector measuring everything

03 **15 days: 1,427 AI reads from 8 engines, 553 real questions, 60 citation clicks**

MY TAKE

Measure instead of assuming.

If AI repeats a stale number about your market, you only find out by checking. Publish clear, dated, machine-readable primary data. Then measure how often AI reads it, answers with it and sends people to it. Without that, you are guessing.

WANT TO SEE HOW I DID IT?

Comment GEO.

I'll send you the step-by-step of this case by DM. I take AI off the drawing board and put it into production, with measured results.

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